FrischMarkt – Scheduled Fresh Market Delivery Service

1. Product Idea

FrischMarkt is a subscription-based fresh grocery delivery and pickup scheduling platform that allows customers to receive fresh products from local German markets on a recurring schedule.

The core idea of the product is simple:

Customers select their preferred **fresh product packages (such as fruit boxes, vegetable bundles, or mixed fresh baskets)** and define **how often they want them delivered or ready for pickup**. Once the schedule is defined, the system automatically repeats the order according to the chosen schedule.

This means that customers do not need to manually reorder groceries every week or month. Instead, the system operates like a **recurring service**, delivering fresh products regularly until the user decides to modify or cancel the schedule.

The product primarily focuses on **fresh products sourced from local or regional suppliers**, which ensures quality and supports regional producers.

The service offers two fulfillment models:

1. **Home Delivery** – products are delivered directly to the customer's address.

2. **Pickup Service** – customers can collect their prepared order from a nearby pickup station or partner store.

Once a user subscribes, the system automatically generates recurring orders based on the selected delivery frequency.

Product Vision

The vision of FrischMarkt is to transform the way people receive fresh groceries by introducing a **predictable, subscription-based delivery ecosystem for fresh food in Germany**.Traditional grocery shopping and most online grocery platforms rely heavily on **manual ordering**, where customers must repeatedly browse products, add items to a cart, and schedule delivery each time they need groceries. This repetitive process creates unnecessary friction for customers who prefer a **consistent supply of fresh produce such as fruits, vegetables, and locally sourced food products**. FrischMarkt aims to shift grocery shopping from a **transaction-driven model to a service-driven experience**, where customers can define their grocery needs once and rely on an automated system to deliver fresh products regularly. The platform enables customers to subscribe to curated bundles of fresh products from regional suppliers and schedule deliveries or pickups based on their preferred frequency. Once the schedule is configured, the service continues automatically until the user decides to modify or pause it.

Through this approach, FrischMarkt seeks to create a **reliable and predictable fresh food supply service**, while also supporting regional producers and improving supply chain efficiency for fresh grocery distribution. The long-term vision is to build a **modern digital infrastructure for fresh food logistics**, connecting local producers, retailers, and consumers through automated scheduling and subscription-based fulfillment.

2. Problem Statement

The German grocery market is highly developed, yet **fresh grocery delivery still faces several structural challenges**, particularly when it comes to convenience, predictability, and supply chain efficiency.

One of the primary issues is that most existing grocery delivery platforms operate on a **manual ordering model**. Customers must repeatedly place orders each week or month, even when their grocery needs remain largely consistent. This creates friction in the user experience and increases the effort required to maintain regular access to fresh food. Customers who regularly purchase fruits, vegetables, or fresh market products often find themselves repeating the same steps: browsing products, adding them to a cart, selecting delivery times, and completing checkout. Over time, this repetitive process discourages consistent use of grocery delivery services.

Another challenge is the **lack of predictable demand for fresh products**. Fresh produce has a short shelf life and requires careful inventory planning. Without predictable demand patterns, retailers and suppliers face difficulties managing procurement and minimizing food waste.

Furthermore, many local farms and regional producers in Germany struggle to access scalable distribution channels. While there is strong consumer interest in locally sourced food, existing grocery platforms often prioritize centralized supply chains rather than regional sourcing.

Urban logistics also adds complexity. Cities such as Berlin, Hamburg, and Munich face growing demand for grocery delivery services, but delivery capacity is limited. Without

predictable order patterns, delivery routes are harder to optimize and operational costs increase.

Existing solutions partially address these issues but still fall short in key areas:

- Rapid delivery platforms focus on speed rather than recurring supply.
- Traditional supermarket delivery services rely heavily on manual ordering.
- Meal kit companies offer subscriptions but limit flexibility in product selection.

As a result, there is currently **no widely adopted platform that combines fresh grocery delivery with automated scheduling and subscription-based fulfillment**.

This gap creates an opportunity to build a system that simplifies grocery access for customers while improving operational efficiency for suppliers and logistics providers.

3. Proposed Solution

FrischMarkt introduces a **subscription-based fresh grocery scheduling platform** designed to provide customers with a reliable and automated supply of fresh products.

The core concept of the platform is to allow users to define their grocery preferences once and have the system automatically repeat deliveries according to their chosen schedule.

Customers can select curated bundles of fresh products such as fruit boxes, vegetable baskets, or mixed produce packages sourced from regional suppliers. After choosing a bundle, users define how often they want to receive it. The platform supports flexible delivery frequencies such as weekly, bi-weekly, or monthly deliveries.

In addition to delivery scheduling, the platform offers multiple fulfillment methods. Customers can choose between **home delivery** or **same-day pickup from nearby collection stations**. This flexibility allows users to select the option that best fits their lifestyle and location.

Once a subscription is activated, the platform automatically generates recurring orders based on the user's selected schedule. The system continues to fulfill these orders until the customer modifies or pauses the service.

To maintain operational reliability, the service follows a **48-hour modification policy**. Customers can change delivery schedules, modify subscriptions, or pause the service up to 48 hours before the next scheduled fulfillment. This ensures that suppliers and logistics partners have sufficient time to prepare fresh products and plan delivery routes efficiently.

By introducing automated scheduling and predictable order cycles, FrischMarkt addresses both customer convenience and supply chain efficiency.

Customers benefit from reduced ordering effort and consistent access to fresh groceries, while suppliers and delivery providers gain improved demand forecasting and route optimization.

Ultimately, the platform aims to create a **more sustainable and efficient fresh food distribution system**, where technology enables seamless coordination between local producers, logistics providers, and consumers.

4. Core Concept of the Scheduling Model

The central functionality of the product is **automated recurring scheduling**.

Customers choose:

- the product bundle
- the delivery or pickup method
- the delivery frequency
- a preferred time window

After the first order is confirmed, the platform automatically repeats the order according to the selected schedule.

Once the subscription is activated, the system will automatically schedule the order every chosen day in week or the ordering timeline chosen unless the customer changes or pauses the subscription.

This eliminates the need for repeated ordering and provides customers with a reliable supply of fresh groceries.

5. Recurring Delivery Business Logic

The service operates using a **recurring subscription model**.

Subscription Activation

When a user completes the initial purchase and payment, the system creates a **subscription record** that stores:

- selected product bundle
- delivery method (home delivery or pickup)
- delivery location or pickup station

- delivery frequency
- preferred delivery time window
- next scheduled delivery date
- payment method

After the subscription is created, the system automatically schedules future orders according to the selected frequency.

Recurring Frequency Options

Typical scheduling intervals include:

- Weekly delivery
- Bi-weekly delivery
- Monthly delivery

The next delivery date is automatically calculated based on the selected frequency.

Automatic Recurring Orders

Once the schedule is defined, the system automatically generates upcoming deliveries.

Each recurring order follows the same configuration:

- same product bundle
- same quantity
- same delivery or pickup method
- same address or pickup station
- same delivery time window

This ensures consistency and reduces the need for manual order placement.

6. Service Change Policy (48-Hour Rule)

To ensure operational reliability, the service uses a **48-hour modification rule**.

Customers can modify or cancel their upcoming delivery **up to 48 hours before the next scheduled fulfillment**.

Allowed changes include:

- changing delivery date
- changing delivery frequency
- switching from delivery to pickup
- changing pickup station
- pausing the subscription
- cancelling the subscription
- changing quantity or bundle

If the user does not make changes before the 48-hour cutoff, the system proceeds with the scheduled order automatically.

This rule is necessary because fresh groceries require **procurement, packaging, and route planning in advance**.

7. Significance of Product

Fresh grocery delivery has grown significantly in Europe, but **most platforms still rely on manual ordering**.

Customers who want fresh groceries every week must repeatedly:

- open an app
- add products to cart
- schedule delivery
- complete checkout

This repetitive behavior creates friction.

FrischMarkt solves this problem by introducing **predictable recurring grocery supply**, similar to subscription models used in other industries.

This is especially useful for:

- families

- busy professionals
- elderly customers
- people who prefer consistent weekly groceries
- customers who prioritize fresh local products

The system transforms grocery shopping from **transaction-based ordering into a service-based recurring experience**.

8. Current Problems in Germany Related to Fresh Grocery Delivery

Germany has a strong grocery market, but there are several structural challenges in the fresh delivery space.

1. Lack of Predictable Fresh Supply

Many grocery platforms operate on a **per-order basis**. Customers must reorder each week, which creates inconvenience.

Customers who want regular fresh vegetables or fruit must repeat the same process every time.

A scheduling model solves this problem.

2. High Operational Complexity for Fresh Products

Fresh products require:

- temperature control
- inventory planning
- short shelf life management
- precise delivery timing

Without predictable demand, retailers struggle to plan inventory efficiently.

A subscription model helps retailers forecast demand more accurately.

3. Fragmented Local Market

Germany has many local producers and regional markets, but connecting them efficiently to customers is difficult.

Traditional grocery chains dominate distribution, but **local farm products often lack scalable delivery channels**.

FrischMarkt can act as a platform that aggregates local fresh supply.

4. Inconvenience of Manual Reordering

Customers who prefer fresh groceries often need to manually reorder every week.

This leads to:

- missed orders
- inconsistent grocery availability
- repeated shopping effort

Automated scheduling removes this friction.

5. Urban Logistics Challenges

Major cities such as Berlin, Hamburg, and Munich have dense populations but complex logistics.

Predictable recurring deliveries allow for:

- optimized route planning
- lower delivery costs
- improved delivery reliability

9. Competitors in Germany

Several companies already operate in the grocery delivery market, but most do not focus heavily on **subscription-based fresh grocery scheduling**.

Rewe Online

A major German supermarket chain offering home grocery delivery and pickup.

Limitations:

- primarily manual ordering
- limited subscription functionality
- fresh produce availability depends on store inventory

Picnic

A popular grocery delivery service operating with fixed delivery routes.

Strengths:

- efficient logistics
- app-based ordering

Limitations:

- still primarily manual ordering
- limited customization of recurring deliveries

HelloFresh

A global meal kit subscription company founded in Germany.

Strengths:

- strong subscription model
- predictable recurring deliveries

Limitations:

- meal kits rather than fresh grocery bundles
- limited flexibility in choosing specific produce bundles

10. How FrischMarkt Solves These Problems

FrischMarkt combines the strengths of several models:

Subscription model

Similar to HelloFresh but focused on **fresh grocery bundles rather than meal kits**.

Flexible delivery scheduling

Users control frequency and delivery time.

Local fresh sourcing

Products come from regional producers and markets.

Automated recurring orders

Customers do not need to reorder each time.

Predictable logistics

Recurring schedules allow for efficient delivery route planning.

11. Benefits for Customers

The service simplifies grocery shopping.

Customers benefit from:

- guaranteed regular fresh groceries
- less time spent ordering
- flexible delivery schedules
- reliable supply of seasonal produce
- support for regional producers
- reduced last-minute grocery shopping stress

12. Benefits for Suppliers and Stores

Local markets and producers benefit as well.

The subscription model provides:

- predictable demand
- better inventory planning
- reduced waste for fresh produce
- stable recurring revenue
- stronger connection between local suppliers and customers

13. Long-Term Impact

If implemented at scale, this model can transform fresh grocery delivery into a **service-driven ecosystem rather than a transaction-based marketplace**.